

CAREER COMPANION PROTOTYPE FLOW

What you will find in this document:

1. WHAT THIS PROTOTYPE IS FOR	2
1.1 BASIC STRATEGIC FRAME & PROTOTYPE SCOPE	2
1.2 TWO HYPOTHESES THE PROTOTYPE WILL HELP TO TEST	2
1.3 A BRIEF NOTE ON TOOL ARCHITECTURE (NOT BUILT NOW, BUT SHAPES HOW THIS IS WRITTEN)	3
2. SCOPE (IN/OUT)	4
IN SCOPE	4
OUT OF SCOPE (FOR NOW)	4
3. THE CONVERSATION FLOW	5
4. THE OUTPUT ARTIFACT – ROLE CARD	6

1. What this prototype is for

1.1 Basic strategic frame & prototype scope

The tool is **for people in career transitions**.

Most AI tools people already use – job-board triage, company research, resume polish, interview role-play - are **tactical**: they help execute a direction already chosen. This platform supplies the **strategic layer underneath that**: the **self-knowledge** a person needs *before* tactical help even makes sense, because you can't prepare for a direction you haven't identified.

The initial raw material for self-knowledge comes from taking a **deep, structured look at the past**. Active reflection on what has actually happened makes thinking about "what's next" **embodied** rather than guessed at or borrowed from a template. No tactical AI tool asks anyone to look backward first - that's the structural gap this fills.

The **prototype** I want to build first is a **structured conversation** – not the user trying to prompt-engineer ChatGPT or Claude themselves, but a **conversation partner** that walks with you through your career role by role and asks the right questions. At the end it gives you back a **structured role summary in your own words** plus the **full transcript**.

All other artefacts and activities that the platform will enable will come next.

Role is understood broadly: while the focus will be on professional roles, distinct structured conversations will also cover education, volunteering activities, significant personal events. The pilot interviews I have conducted in the past 10 days have all supported “full-life thesis”: one’s career choices are indissociable from one’s life stages and events.

1.2 Two hypotheses the prototype will help to test

There are two value hypotheses that I would like to test with this prototype, tracking and reporting them jointly, but separately.

- **Value Hypothesis A: Comfort/convenience.** The conversation feels comfortable and low-friction, meaningfully different from a job interview, while sharing material about past roles.
- **Value Hypothesis B: Genuine self-awareness increase (the real bet).** The session produces understanding the person didn't have articulated 20 minutes earlier: not just an accurate summary of what they already knew, but something new about how they take up roles, what drives them, what shuts them down, what they have “forgotten”. As this understanding grows and gets

fine-tuned with every role conversation, patterns become visible, “surprises” emerge.

B is the one the business depends on. A is necessary for retention but is not the value itself. If A is high and B is absent, the prototype has built a pleasant conversational UI with nothing underneath - a real failure dressed as a partial success. If A is lower than hoped but B is strong, that's more survivable, as friction is fixable; absence of insight is not fixable by polishing the UX.

In addition to testing the above hypotheses, at the end of the pilot sessions I would like to ask the pilot users two questions:

- What would make you use a tool like this and pay for it, **instead of** simply using ChatGPT/Claude/etc?
- **What else** would make something like this tool **actually worth using for you?**

1.3 A brief note on tool architecture (not built now, but shapes how this is written)

The reflection loop being tested here – **elicit > structure > produce an artifact > hand it back for use in the real world** - is not unique to past roles. The same loop applies to present-tense experience (not yet built) and imagined futures (not yet built), differing only in time-orientation and trigger. **The platform's job, end to end, is to enhance self-knowledge through active voice reflection and artifact; the action and the real conversations always happen outside it**, whether that "outside" is a workplace, a coach's office, a walk with a friend or a family dinner.

2. Scope (IN/OUT)

IN scope

- **Web-based**
- **Text/Voice:** I would really love to have **voice input** for the prototype (with text as another available option). I understood from a chat with a founder friend that they could build a web-based demo with voice input.
- **English**
- **Partial interview protocol**
- **One role only** per session
- **A fixed, non-branching sequence of questions** - no conditional checks in this build
- **One generated output artifact:** the Role Card (raw, not job-interview optimised)

OUT of scope (for now)

- **Voice input/output**
- **Multi-lingual (English, French to start with)**
- **Full conversation protocol** for professional roles
- **Full conversation protocols** for volunteering roles, education, significant personal events.
- **Conditional/branching questions** to go back and clarify certain answers
- Specific conversation sub-protocols that can not only elucidate answers but implicitly train the user (for example, achievement/impact sub-protocol that can help the user see his/her impact in a new light)
- **Multi-role Career Map** assembly
- **Other artifacts/reports:** patterns, tell me about yourself pitches, skills chart, CV, motivation letters
- Present-tense and future-tense reflection loops & activities
- Cross-session memory
- Mobile, visual polish
- Any job interview-prep-optimized derived output

3. The conversation flow

Fixed sequence, one question at a time. This initial build has **no conditional checks** — every question is asked plainly, in order, once.

Step	Description
Opening	Let's build a picture of one professional role you've had. Please pick one to start with and I'll ask you a few questions. Before we start, let's agree to talk about it as if you were talking to a trusted friend, not to a recruiter, OK? It will take us about 15–20 minutes, and at the end you'll get the role summary, in your own words.
1	Let's start with the basics. What was the role, its exact title?
2	When was it roughly, how long did it last?
3	What is the name of the company?
4	Which industry was it?
5	Please tell me how you learned about the role. Was it through a referral, a headhunter or anything else? And what made you take it?
6	How would you describe the overall business context of the company when you joined, for example, growth, restructuring, something else?
7	Which part of the business were you joining and how big was it?
8	What exactly were you hired to do, how clear were the expectations?
9	Who was your hiring manager? What was your relationship like and what part did they play in what happened for you in this role?
10	Were you leading a team, and if yes, how big was it and how many direct reports did you have?
11	Please tell me about the environment you were in – the practical rhythm like hours and work from home flexibility, the physical space and the culture around you? Which of those mattered most?
12	How long did it take you to take the role and feel comfortable in it? What were the key things you did to become autonomous and confident in the role?
13	Now, please walk me through your typical working day in this role: what did you do, what were the tools you used and who were the people and teams you were most frequently interacting with.
14	Which parts of your typical working day energized you, gave you a sense of meaning and momentum?
15	Which parts of your typical working day drained you or felt like a grind?
16	How would you describe your biggest achievements in this role?
17	When you think about your time in this role, what did you like the most?
18	And again, when you think about your entire time in the role, what were you missing?
19	What was your biggest challenge in this role?
20	If you are no longer in this role, how did it end?
21	Lastly, if there is one key thing you learned from this role – it could be an insight, a skill, really, anything else – what would that be?
22	What else is important for you for this role that we have not discussed?
Closing	Thank you, that's everything for this role. Please give me a moment to put this together.

4. The output artifact – Role Card

The Role Card stays inside the philosophical spine of the tool - authentic, in the person's own words, no corporate polish, not optimized for external use. It is near-transcript, structured but not translated into achievement-framed, recruiter-legible language. It should include what drained the person as readily as what energised them.

The structure:

- **Headline** – one sentence capturing the shape of the role – QQ1-4
- **The biggest insight** - one or two lines, in their words – Q21
- **Getting the role** – one or two lines, in their words – Q5
- **The business context** of the company – one or two sentences capturing QQ6-7
- **The expectations** – one sentence capturing expectations and their clarity Q8
- **The manager & the team** – one or two sentences capturing Q9-10, in their own words
- **The environment factor** – one line naming what feature mattered most from the answer to Q11
- **Getting into the role** – their own account of what and how long it took to be autonomous Q12
- **Micro-look at the role:** told briefly, close to their own words, QQ13-15
- **Macro-look at the role:** a summary, close to their own words, of the bigger picture of the role, QQ 16-19
- **Extra thoughts:** if anything specific in mention in the answer to Q22
- **Ending:** a brief summary, in their words – if the role is not current. Q20